

GNU Linux-Libre 6.12 kernel released for users seeking 100% freedom

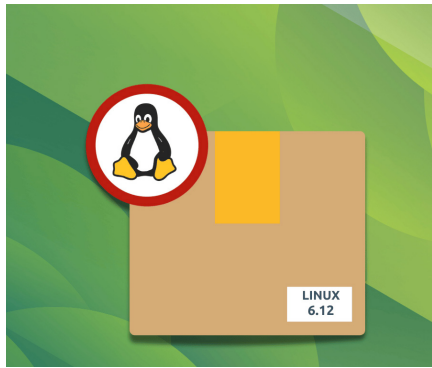
The GNU Linux-libre project has announced the release of the GNU Linux-libre 6.12 kernel, designed for software freedom enthusiasts and users who seek complete freedom for their GNU/Linux systems.

Based on the newly released Linux 6.12 kernel series, the GNU Linux-libre 6.12 version includes several clean-up efforts, such as the removal of CPM/QE QMC SoC support, Realtek 8852BE-VT Wi-Fi driver, Amlogic BT protocol support, amcc qt2025 phy driver, and aw96103/aw96105 proximity sensor. Additionally, the release features updates to clean up Renesas xHCI controllers and the Intel ISH (Integrated Sensor Hub) HID driver, as well as updates to blob names for various drivers like Qualcomm q6v5 remoteproc, r8169, rtw8852c, and rtw8922a.

The GNU Linux-libre 6.12 kernel offers a truly free alternative for users who want their PCs to be entirely free from proprietary components and non-free software. It can be accessed through the official GNU Linux-libre repository and can be downloaded as compressed tarballs from the official website.

Additionally, ready-to-use binary packages for Debian-based (DEB) and Red Hat-based (RPM) distributions are available for download from the Fresh and RPM Freedom websites.

The GNU Linux-libre kernel can be installed on almost any GNU/Linux distribution, either as a replacement for the standard kernel or alongside it.



“No strange surprises this last week, so we’re sticking to the regular release schedule, and that obviously means that the merge window opens tomorrow. I already have two dozen+ pull requests in my mailbox, kudos to all the early birds,” said Linus Torvalds, creator and lead developer of the Linux kernel.

Google to integrate Android frameworks into Chrome OS

Google is reportedly working on merging Chrome OS into the Android ecosystem, aiming to create a unified platform that enhances the user experience, especially for Android tablet users.

Earlier this year, Google had outlined plans to integrate components of Android’s codebase into Chrome OS. Key highlights included adopting elements of the Android Linux kernel and Android frameworks to strengthen compatibility and improve functionality across devices.

This integration signals a shift toward a more seamless experience between Android and Chrome OS, blurring the lines between the two platforms while potentially paving the way for innovative cross-platform features.



“To continue rolling out new Google AI features to users at a faster and even larger scale, we’ll be embracing portions of the Android stack, like the Android Linux kernel and Android frameworks, as part of the foundation of ChromeOS,” explained Google, in a post.

According to a report from *Android Authority*, this strategic initiative is seen as a direct response to Apple’s continued dominance in the global tablet market.

Despite a year-on-year decline of approximately 6%, Apple retained a commanding 32% market share in the tablet segment during Q3 2024.

While Google has not officially commented on the project, the integration is viewed as a tactical move to enhance the Android tablet experience and establish a stronger foothold in the competitive tablet landscape. By merging the strengths of Chrome OS with Android, Google aims to deliver a more unified and versatile platform, positioning itself as a formidable contender against Apple.

Red Hat and SoftBank join forces to develop AI-RAN technologies for smarter, greener networks

Red Hat and SoftBank Corp. have announced a collaboration to advance